MINUTES OF THE CITY OF HOLLADAY
CITY COUNCIL MEETING

Thursday, April 3, 2025
5:30 p.m.
City Council Chambers
4580 South 2300 East
Holladay, Utah

ATTENDANCE:

Mayor Rob Dahle
Paul Fotheringham
Emily Gray
Matt Durham
Ty Brewer
Drew Quinn

City Staff:
Gina Chamness, City Manager
Todd Godfrey, City Attorney
Christian Larsen, Finance Director
Jared Bunch, City Engineer
Stephanie Carlson, City Recorder

I. ***Welcome*** – Mayor Rob Dahle.
Mayor Dahle called the City Council Work Meeting to order at 5:30 p.m. He informed those present that here are no action items scheduled to be voted on, but there will be City Council discussions.

II. ***Granite School District Boundary Presentation –*** *Steve Hogan.*
Director of Planning and Boundaries for Granite School District, Steve Hogan, introduced himself to the City Council and reviewed some of his professional background. He shared the Granite School District Elementary Boundary and Closure Study (Area 5) presentation slides and explained that this is the Area 5 Elementary Study. A map was shared highlighting the location of the elementary schools. Mr. Hogan reviewed a table with the schools as well as relevant information, such as the enrollment numbers and the building capacity. The Facility Condition Index ("FCI") is listed for each. No building on the list is unsafe, but certain numbers indicate that there will be more maintenance needed and the building is closer to a remodel or a new build.

As for why the study has been conducted, it has to do with declining student enrollment. Mr. Hogan shared some information related to enrollment, including a graph that tracks the 20-Year Enrollment numbers. This past year, the number dropped to 55,546 enrolled students. He next shared a graph that looks at the 20-Year Enrollment + 5-Year Forecast. This does not simply include projections from the Granite School District, as a demographic company was hired to look at and confirm the data. It is expected there will be a decrease of approximately 1,000 students per year. Based on the projection, there will be 47,518 students enrolled in the Granite School District in 2029. This is not a district-specific issue, but reflects a pattern that is being seen across the State

Mr. Hogan pointed out that there is often a misconception that larger schools mean larger classrooms with more students in each, but that is not the case. There is a student teacher ratio, so if there are more students, there are more teachers. There is an economy of scale that needs to be considered.

Mr. Hogan explained that schools are not closed to save money. Schools are closed to ensure the sizing is correct and a better educational experience is provided. He shared the Study Process information and explained that it is almost a full calendar year process. There are different meetings held, and a lot of feedback is received. There is a final decision made in December, with any changes implemented the next fall. There will be no changes made in this next school year.

Council Member Drew Quinn asked about the Dual Language Immersion programs. Mr. Hogan explained that with a program like that, it is almost like running two schools. To have some of the special programs, there needs to be more students. Council Member Emily Gray asked if the students in these programs are included in the school population numbers, which was confirmed. Mr. Hogan suggested that Council Members look at the website, as it shows how many students live in each area, how many students are attending, and where those students are coming from.

Discussions were had about school closures. Mr. Hogan reiterated that there are many considerations. A few years back, there was a study conducted with over 20 schools, and there was one school closure. There have been other years where there were three of the nine schools studied that were closed. There are a lot of factors that need to be considered in this process. Mr. Hogan shared an example scenario with Redwood Elementary School and the different factors considered. During the study, it is necessary to look at the surrounding schools and consider the impact a school closure would have on all of the remaining schools. Additional example scenarios were shared.

Mr. Hogan explained that data is considered, but there is also a desire to receive feedback from others. There is a lot that can be learned through public input. He further reviewed the study process. There have been some meetings held already, and there are some more meetings scheduled. He asked that those interested submit feedback on the website, as he is interested in comments and creative suggestions. December is when the final approval will take place.

Council Member Gray asked who looks at the data and determines how much each factor weighs in. Mr. Hogan reported that the Population Analysis Committee ("PAC") discusses those details. At an average meeting, there are between 25 and 30 participants. There is not always consensus, but there is normally enough feedback received to take recommendations back to the Board. In the end, it is a Board decision that is made. He shared additional information about PAC members.

Mayor Dahle expressed appreciation for the presentation and the information shared. The City Council has already received some inquiries, so any information provided to the Council is appreciated. Mayor Dahle noted that the QR code can be included in the Holladay Journal.

III. *2025 Legislative Update –* *David and Ashley Spatafore.*

Mayor Dahle reported that David and Ashley Spatafore are present to share a 2025 Legislative update with the City Council. Ms. Spatafore discussed some of the housing-related bills and informed the Council that the Housing Commission will continue. House Bill ("H.B.") 37 – Utah Housing Amendments deals with housing development and housing policy. The density overlay can allow for a density bonus. If this is implemented, restrictions can be placed This bill gives cities the tool to place certain restrictions with additional density.

H.B. 256 – Municipal Zoning Amendments is a bill that modifies short-term rental provisions related to the authority of municipalities and counties. It clarifies that municipalities and counties

may use a website listing as evidence that a short-term rental took place, in addition to other supporting information. This can also be used for tax collection to ensure that occurs.

Senate Bill ("S.B.") 181 – Housing Affordability Amendments was reviewed. Ms. Spatafore explained that this bill enacts and amends provisions related to housing and affordable housing funding. It enacts provisions of municipal land use regulations with regard to certain types of parking spaces. Mayor Dahle asked how this will impact the City. It was noted that a slight adjustment will be needed.

H.B. 48 – Wildland Urban Interface Modifications was reviewed. Ms. Spatafore noted that this bill will impact Holladay, and it will likely be an iterative process. The bill requires counties to take certain actions related to Wildland Urban Interface properties, including assessing a fee. This will hopefully assist with homeowner insurance. She shared additional information about the bill and noted that the County will oversee this process. Council Member Paul Fotheringham is curious about some of the unknowns, such as what the role of the Unified Fire Authority ("UFA") will be and whether they will receive a portion of the fee.

Discussions were had about Forestry, Fire, and State Lands ("FFSL") and the bill. Mr. Spatafore reported that this bill impacts Holladay and Millcreek more than some other cities. Council Member Ty Brewer asked about insurance companies and whether this bill will compel insurance companies to provide some sort of coverage. Ms. Spatafore explained that it is possible to share the risk assessment and mitigation efforts. That can be used to show the fire reduction efforts.

H.B. 198 – Highway Expansion Impacts on Signage Amendments was discussed. This bill amends provisions related to the relocation of a billboard due to road construction or other highway changes. It pushes relocation more clearly onto local government. If local government somehow prohibits relocation, then there is a concern that the local government will need to cover the cost. He is thankful this is not something that will have much of an impact in Holladay. The Council reviewed the bill language

H.B. 502 – Transportation and Infrastructure Funding Amendments and the process that took place. On the last night of the Session, there were certain changes made to the bill. It provided funding to the County of the First Class Infrastructure Bank Fund, which was a new concept. He reported that Salt Lake County can enact the "fifth of a fifth," which is an extra 0.2% of the sales tax and he has heard that will happen as soon as July. Part of that would go to the cities, part would go to Salt Lake County, part would go to the new County of the First Class Infrastructure Bank Fund, and part would be used to fund the express bus route on 5600 West. City Manager, Gina Chamness, asked if the Legislature would control this fund. Mr. Spatafore believed that it was something that needs to be discussed. The Legislature is going to appropriate it, but there should be a discussion at the Conference of Mayors level about the development of a process that looks at what the infrastructure needs are in the County. If the residents are paying into this, then there should be a fair and open process that is established.

Mr. Spatafore further discussed H.B. 502 and the last-minute changes that were included. Part of the infrastructure money authorized the issuance of up to $70 million in General Obligation Transportation Bonds for affordable housing grant programs in Salt Lake County. This is something that Holladay might be able to benefit from, depending on the rules that are developed. However, he expressed concerns about the Legislature making determinations about local funding.

As a result, he believes a conversation is needed within the Conference of Mayors. Additional discussions were had about H.B. 502 and Mayor Dahle stressed the importance of education. There are some meetings scheduled with a few of the new County Council representatives. Mayor Dahle thanked Mr. Spatafore and Ms. Spatafore for sharing Legislative updates with the Council.

IV. *Review of City Survey –* *Kyrene Gibb with Y2 Analytics.*

Mayor Dahle reported that Kyrene Gibb from Y2 Analytics is present to share information about the City survey that was conducted. Ms. Gibb reviewed some of the key findings from the survey, which are as follows:

- Respondents believe that Holladay is heading in the right direction and give their quality of life an overall rating of 82/100. 90% respondents are at least somewhat likely to recommend Holladay to their friends and family;
- In the open-ended responses, many people mentioned Holladay's small-town charm, natural beauty, and community as reasons to why they love the City. Some raised concerns about population growth and traffic as things to prioritize in the next 3-5 years;
- A total of 65% of respondents believe they are receiving an excellent or good service value for their tax dollars. Among individual City services, community events, garbage collection, and fire/emergency were highly rated. When asked where they would invest their budget for improvements, respondents allocated more money on average to surface maintenance of streets and roads than other services;
- A large majority of respondents (82%) do not use public transport, and among these non-users, 41% remain unlikely to use public transit even if proposed changes are implemented; and
- Majority of respondents (82%) agree that sustainability is an important goal for Holladay to pursue. They believe preserving and growing trees and water conservation should be the highest priority projects to meet this goal.

Ms. Gibb shared information about the survey methodology. For this survey, there was a new random sample of residents used and there were 800 Holladay residents who completed the survey. . Interviews were completed online between February 20 and March 17, 2025, and the outreach methods included postcard invitations and text message reminders as well as some email invitations. The interviews conducted result in a margin of error of plus or minus 3.4 percentage points.

The City Health and Quality of Life information was reviewed. Ms. Gibb reported that on average, Holladay residents rate the quality of life at 82, which is five points higher than in 2022. There is a positive attitude about the quality of life in the City overall. Across the different Council Districts, the average is 80 or higher, so there are not specific areas of the City that are expressing disproportionate levels of discontent.

There were high approval ratings for City Officials, with 82% of respondents approving of the City Council and Mayor, which is slightly higher than in 2022. District 3 had an especially strong approval rating. The vast majority of residents are at least somewhat likely to recommend Holladay to friends and family. This has increased slightly since 2022, from 88% to 90%. Some of the things residents particularly like about the City include the location, sense of community, the aesthetics of the community, and the quality of the neighbors and neighborhoods. As for what sets Holladay apart from other communities along the Wasatch Front, residents mentioned the

sense of community, trees, and charm. The main issues that residents would like to see the City focus on in the next three to five years are related to growth, traffic, and housing.

The City Services information was reviewed. Approximately two-thirds of residents believe they receive an excellent or good value for their tax dollars, which has increased by eight percentage points compared to 2022. Overall, a strong majority of residents feel it is safe to live in Holladay and it is a great place to raise a family. There is an increase in those numbers compared to 2022. The safety rating has gone from 82% to 91% since 2022.

The one area where there is a little bit more division is the share of residents who feel the City is growing and developing in a positive way. 54% agree with that sentiment, which is still higher than 2022, even though that is the lowest-rated sentiment in this set. Council Member Fotheringham pointed out that the word growth in an infill community can scare some residents. As for business opportunities in the City, there were additional kinds of businesses that residents would like to see, such as locally owned restaurants and cafes and locally owned retail stores.

Community events, City parks, and emergency preparedness are the highest rated services relative to the other in-house City services. Overall, the services are moderately rated with the lowest being 46%. The lowest ranked are planning, zoning, and building services and sidewalk maintenance. Ms. Gibb believes the planning, zoning, and building services number reflects resident attitudes towards growth and development more than actual interactions. The open-ended responses do not tend to mention specific issues with Planning and Zoning. The number seems to be more of an expression of growing pains than attitudes about the City department itself.

Residents were asked about Code Enforcement. Ms. Gibb explained that Code Enforcement is an area where it is better for residents to elaborate so there is clarity about whether there is too much or not enough enforcement. There were a lot of comments about sidewalks.

The Neighborhood Improvements data was shared. When it comes to resident attitudes towards their own neighborhoods, there was a positive sentiment overall about the aesthetic of the neighborhood and how connected neighborhoods are to the City. The perception of the connectedness of neighborhoods has increased compared to 2022. The walkability of Holladay neighborhoods is also highly rated.

Approximately one-third of residents have reported contacting a City office in the last year. When residents were asked to speak about their experiences, there were positive attitudes overall about the customer service experience. Most of the discontent residents expressed had to do with the resolution of their issue not going the way they would have preferred or it not happening as quickly as they would have preferred. 46% of residents were satisfied with the City's response and 41% were at least somewhat dissatisfied. There were largely concerns about the resolution.

Ms. Gibb reviewed the City Initiatives and Focus Areas information. 82% of residents feel it is at least somewhat important that the City prioritize sustainability. Residents would be most supportive of preserving and planting trees, water conservation, waste management, and reducing carbon emissions/improving air quality. Transitioning to renewable energy sources is appealing to 47% and a third of residents are interested in seeing the City encourage more alternative forms of transportation. As for housing and development in the City, there are consistent themes with what has been seen in the past. However, the interest in having some form of higher density or

mixed-use development somewhere in the City has increased slightly compared to 2022. Other than that, the patterns remain similar. Residents are most interested in single-family homes in their area. 26% of residents feel that apartments are necessary or would be nice to have somewhere in the City. That has increased compared to 2022, which speaks to a resident focus on housing issues. Ms. Chamness asked if it is possible to break those responses down by age, which was confirmed.

Council Member Brewer thought it would be interesting to see some comparisons with other cities. Ms. Gibb reported that there has not been a formal aggregation of that data. Mayor Dahle thought it made sense to focus on opportunities for improvement based on the survey results. This information can be used to prioritize the budgeting process that will take place in the next few weeks. Additional discussions were had about the results of the survey. Ms. Gibb noted that Council Member questions can be shared with Y2 Analytics via email. Mayor Dahle thanked her for the work put into the survey. He stated that the survey results are useful to the City Council.

V. *Discussion on Financial Policy –* *Christian Larsen.*

Mayor Dahle reported that Finance Director Christian Larsen, will discuss the City of Holladay Financial Policies document. There has been a collaborative effort to create the document that is included in the packet. Mr. Larsen stated that this is a draft document. He is interested in receiving feedback on what can be improved to better align with the Council vision. The general purpose of the document is to set parameters and guidelines for prudent fiscal operational practices and management. The General Fund Reserve policies were reviewed. The State requires municipalities to maintain an unrestricted General Fund balance between 5% and 35% of General Fund revenues. The document states that Holladay will maintain a General Fund balance of no less than 15% of budgeted General Fund revenues. Last year, the City was at 33.6%.

Mr. Larsen discussed the Storm Water Utility Fund. He reported that Holladay will strive to maintain working capital of no less than 60 days' worth of annual operating expenses in the Storm Water Utility Fund. Discussions were had about the Storm Water Utility Fund. Mr. Larsen reported that it is best to have some cushion between current assets and current liabilities so it is possible to cover those liabilities in the short term.

The Revenue policy information was shared. Mr. Larsen read the following language: "Holladay will not use one-time revenues towards ongoing expenditures." He next read the following: "Administrative fees will be charged by the General Fund to the Enterprise Funds to recapture direct and indirect costs which benefit all funds." The original amount set to be charged was established when the fund was first created. Ms. Chamness believed the amount was based on a percentage of the administrative time.

In the Expenditure policy section, it states: "If the midpoint of the City's salary range is more than 5% below the market for any given position, the grade of that particular position will be adjusted upward." There were some Staff discussions about adding additional language to clarify that this would be subject to budget constraints or subject to the discretion of the City Manager, so there would be some flexibility. Under the Operating Budget policy, it states: "The City Manager has authority to reallocate line items within a department budget, but any interdepartmental budget adjustments must be approved by the City Council." This is a fairly standard policy for cities. Mayor Dahle wondered whether there should be a limit in place for what can be reallocated. Ms. Chamness shared information about the UFA policy that is currently in place. Discussions were had about the proposed policy. Mr. Larsen reported that auditors review the Financial

Statements at the end of the year and look at things from a department level and shared some examples.

The Capital Asset Management section was reviewed. Mr. Larsen highlighted the following language: "The City of Holladay will develop and maintain a Capital Improvement Plan, which includes realistic project timing, scope, and operating budget impacts." He also pointed out the following: "Funds remaining in the project budget after its completion may be appropriated for other capital projects." In the Long-Term Financial Planning section, it states: "Each year, Staff shall develop a forecast of operating expenditures and revenue for the next five years."

Mr. Larsen next reviewed the Procurement policy information. This folds into the existing policy in the City Code. It states that the City will comply with all Federal laws and regulations for procurement. The Cash Receiving and Deposit section outlines the types of checks the City will not accept. This section also states that the City will be in compliance with the State Laws regarding deposit policies. As for the Investment policy section, it states: "All funds will be invested in accordance with the most recent revision of the Utah Money Management Act."

The Credit Card Payment section was discussed. Mr. Larsen noted that it states the City will not give cash advances on credit cards and will not accept partial payments with credit cards. In addition, credit card payments will not be accepted over the phone or by mail due to the risks involved. If a refund is issued, then it will always be back onto the card that made the original transaction

Mayor Dahle reported the intention is to adopt the City of Holladay Financial Policies document by Resolution. He thanked City Staff for their efforts on this policy-related document.

VI. ***Overlay Update –*** *Jared Bunch.*

Mayor Dahle asked City Engineer, Jared Bunch, to discuss the overlay update. Mr. Bunch shared the Summary Report for the proposed mill and overlay streets under County contract. He reported that there is a map included in the Meeting Materials Packet. The streets on the map are proposed to be repaved by Salt Lake County under the Fiscal Year 2026 contract. In the previous three years, additional money has been spent outside of the County contract, which was from the bond funds. A year ago, there was uncertainty whether there would be money left over for additional paving projects. It turns out there is no additional funding for paving projects in the spring.

Council Member Gray noted that District 4 has three of the worst roads and asked why those are not being addressed. Mr. Bunch explained that there has been communication with Salt Lake City about the water mains in the roads and the leaks that occur. These roads are on the project list, but the City has been informed that the work will not be funded this year. Repaving is needed, but after that happens, the water main work might still move forward. It is possible to reach out again about the necessary water main work so this matter can be further considered. Additional discussions were had about the roadwork and what is proposed on the map for the Salt Lake County work. Mayor Dahle noted that during the retreat, a commitment was made to prioritize the roads. The survey results seem to indicate that the roads are important to the residents of Holladay.

VII. ***Closed Session Pursuant to Utah Code Section 52-4-204 and 205.***

There was no Closed Session.

VIII. ***Adjourn.***

Council Member Fotheringham moved to ADJOURN. Council Member Quinn seconded the motion. The motion passed with the unanimous consent of the Council.

The City Council Meeting adjourned at approximately 8:03 p.m.

I hereby certify that the foregoing represents a true, accurate, and complete record of the Holladay City Council Meeting held Thursday, April 3, 2025.

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Stephanie N. Carlson, MMC
Holladay City Recorder

Robert Dahle, Mayor

Minutes approved: **August 7, 2025**